Naiara Manteiga Cendón

Computer Engineering Student

Contact

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LinkedIn

GDG A Coruña Portal

Portfolio

Education

University of A Coruña (UDC) - Spain
Bachelor's degree in Computer Engineering - taught in English
2022-2027

- GPA ≈ 3.30 (7,11/10 Spanish scale)

Pécsi Tudományegyetem - Pécs, Hungary
Bachelor's degree in Computer Engineering - Erasmus+
2024-2025

Ashley Ridge High School - Summerville, South Carolina
High school diploma
2018-2020

- Award for academic excellence

Languages

Spanish - Native
Galician - Native
English - Fluent

- C2.1 - Language School UDC
- C1 - Trinity College
- C1 - Aptis

Hard skills

- AI & Data: TensorFlow, Keras, Scikit-learn, Pandas, NumPy, OpenCV, neuroevolution techniques and Spiking Neural Networks (SNNs).
- Programming Languages: Python, C, Java, Clingo (ASP), JavaScript, HTML, CSS.
- Development, Version Control & DevOps: Git, Git LFS, Azure DevOps, REST API deployment (FastAPI), Maven.
- Development Environments & Systems: Unix/Linux terminal workflows (Zsh), VS Code, PyCharm, IntelliJ IDEA.
- Game Development Tools: Unity 3D, Godot.
- Design & Modeling: Blender, AutoCAD, Procreate.
- Office & Productivity Tools: Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Teams, Notion and Google Meet.

Soft skills

- Leadership skills.
- Hard-working.
- Creative mind, full of ideas.
- Strong analytical and problem-solving skills.
- Patient, proactive and with good communication skills.
- Strong organization and time management skills.

About me

I am a final-year Computer Engineering student at the University of A Coruña, specializing in Computer Science. I have one course and my bachelor's thesis left to complete my degree, so I will graduate in February 2027. My bachelor's thesis focuses on researching improvements to the NEAT algorithm (NeuroEvolution of Augmented Topologies) by applying Spiking Neural Networks (SNNs) and Reward-Modulated Spike-Timing-Dependent Plasticity (R-STDP) and how that can be used for Robotics, Aerospace and multiple AI learning environments.

I have a strong interest in programming, algorithms, artificial intelligence (AI), business intelligence (BI) and applied research. I lived in the United States for 2 years and spent a year in Hungary on an Erasmus exchange program, experiences that have strengthened my intercultural and language skills.

I am also the co-founder and Communication Manager of Google Developer Group A Coruña, where I organize events and manage communications for the local tech community. In addition, since November 2026, I have been part of the WordPress Marketing team, where I will be writing tech articles for the official WordPress blog.

Volunteering Experience

Co-founder & Communication Manager, Google Developer Group A Coruña
August 2024 – Present
As part of the GDG A Coruña organizing team, I actively help run tech events in A Coruña (as well as in other parts of Galicia and online). This role also lets me attend workshops across Spain organized by Google and Google Developer Experts. Beyond organizing, I lead the creative team and the social media campaigns that promote our events. Some of these events include:

- **Panelist at the WordCamp A Coruña 2026 Community Day round table**
- **DevFest 2025 in collaboration with GDG Ourense**
  A day-and-a-half event with talks and workshops across a range of computing fields, bringing together 251 attendees. We hosted 12 speakers, and the event was held at the ESEI.
- **Hacktoberfest 2024, 2025 & 2026 in collaboration with PythonCoruña & GPUL**
  A one-day hackathon that brought together around 80 attendees at the UDC campus in Riazor.
- **Kubernetes & AI, con sentidiño, in collaboration with GPUL**

Marketing & Communications Contributor (Open Source), WordPress Spain Community
November 2026 – Present
Writing technical and educational articles for the official es.WordPress.org blog.
Asynchronous collaboration using remote-work tools (Slack, Google Workspace) to create community communication guides.

Hackathons & Competitions

- **Participant, C3TF A Coruña (2026)**
  A teammate and I found different ways to bypass the cybersecurity of various challenges and tools in a Capture The Flag (CTF) format.
- **Winner, Impacthon organized by GDG Santiago (2026)**
  In 36 hours, my team and I built a website that visualizes proteins in 3D and VR/AR using several Google tools.
  - I deployed the website's backend on Google Cloud and built an agent that summarizes protein information and comparisons.
- **BrinQo Quantum GameJam (2026)**
  My team and I created a card game whose cards were based on quantum concepts.
  - I handled the main game programming in Godot, based on my teammates' design.
- **Participant, HackUDC organized by GPUL (2026)**
  My teammate and I developed a program that ran the famous video game DOOM on a satellite. The judges praised our technical skill and innovative ideas.
  - I developed, in C, the satellite subsystem for an interactive video streaming link based on the DOOM engine. I implemented an asynchronous network architecture over UDP with non-blocking sockets and designed a state machine to mitigate latency. On the engine side, I used memory injection to bridge legacy systems and map controls in real time.
- **Winner, AI Körber Innovathon (2024–2025) – Prize: €7,500**
  My team and I developed a neural network able to process Excel files containing large amounts of industrial data for a Hungarian company (Körber). The program processed and summarized the data at a high level and displayed the results through an executable.
  - I mainly developed and trained the neural network and generated the final Excel report.
- **Participant, HackUDC organized by GPUL (2024)**
  I developed a simple obstacle-dodging video game on my own.
- **Participant, CanSat project (2022)**
  My team and I built a model using Arduino and 3D printing, programmed in C, capable of exchanging data with the ground station from high altitudes.
- **Winner, XIII Rita Suárez Poetry Contest (2018) – Prize: a published book of my poetry**